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Correct Answer

Next Question

Practice Exam - 1

Question 102 of 117



A 68 year old man presents to clinic for evaluation for advanced therapies. He has a past medical history significant for ischemic cardiomyopathy, ventricular tachycardia, and chronic left ventricular thrombus. He denies alcohol, cannabis, and illicit substances and does not take any OTC or herbal medications. He is currently receiving the following medications: amiodarone 200 mg daily, mexiletine 150 mg twice daily, apixaban 5 mg twice daily, omeprazole 20 mg daily, bisoprolol 5 mg daily, sacubitril/valsartan 49-51 mg daily, pregabalin 75 mg daily, rosuvastatin 10 mg daily, spironolactone 25 mg daily.

When evaluating the patient's labs, his urine toxicology screen returns positive for methamphetamine. When asked again about use, he emphatically denies methamphetamine use.

Which of the following medications is responsible for this patient's positive methamphetamine test?

A. Omeprazole



B. Pregabalin



C. Mexiletine

D. Spironolactone

Commentary

References

Testing Point: As part of the advanced therapies evaluation, the Board-certified AHFTC specialist should recognize medications which could cause false positive urine drug screens.

Answer: C. Mexiletine

Illicit drug use is widely accepted as an absolute contraindication to many advanced medical therapies such as transplantation. Clinical practice guidelines list active or recent illicit drug use as a class III recommendation for heart transplantation and durable mechanical circulatory support. Patients with advanced heart failure commonly have ventricular arrhythmias treated with

antiarrhythmics, such as mexiletine. Mexiletine is structurally similar to amphetamine and methamphetamine which explains the false-positive amphetamine immunoassay result, making Answer C correct.

Proton pump inhibitors have been documented to cause a false positive urine drug screen for THC, making Answer A incorrect.

Neither pregabalin or spironolactone have been associated with false positive urine drug screens, making Answers B and D as incorrect.

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